Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting - November 2nd, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2pZcQMSTQPY
Publication Date	2026-11-03T04:20:29Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Board of Commissioners — Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: November 2, 2026
Body: Delaware County Board of Commissioners

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order at 9:00 AM (00:05:48), followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Commissioner Henry, Commissioner Bran, Commissioner Rian (Presiding Officer/President), and Attorney John Brook.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening prayer/invocation (not explicitly transcribed) and Pledge of Allegiance (00:05:54–00:06:11). Recognition of the monthly employee of the month:

Lori Miner from the Delaware County Auditor's Office (00:06:31–00:09:03).

- **Approval of Minutes:** Motion and second to approve the minutes of October 19 (00:11:43–00:11:45).
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (00:11:49–00:11:52).

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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:09:37 **Removal of Tax Sale Property (1943 West 8th Street):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Legal Counsel.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding Mr. Robinson's ongoing request to acquire and maintain a property obtained via commissioner's tax sale. It did not meet the legal definition of "abutting" due to an intervening alley. Legal notice was given to actual abutting landowners, none of whom made an offer. Mr. Robinson previously offered $500 (the minimum bid).
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to accept Mr. Robinson's $500 offer. Passed Unanimously (00:11:15–00:11:20).
- 00:12:08 **Memorial Request for Matthew Mory (Old Iron Bridge / Granville Bridge):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Josh Coons (00:12:12).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Josh Coons requested approval to install a stainless steel memorial for Matthew Mory—who tragically lost his life due to recent flooding—at the Old Iron Bridge. The memorial will be secured using 316 stainless steel U-bolts without drilling, cutting, or welding into the bridge structure. County Engineer Dean Thomas noted there are suitable mounting options on site. The board recommended coordinating a small ceremony with the family and highway department.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve Mr. Coon's request. Passed Unanimously (00:16:05–00:16:15).
- 00:16:24 **Emergency Management Rapid Grant (Ball Brothers Foundation):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Cory Kirk, Emergency Management (00:16:24).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Reported the receipt of a $5,000 rapid grant from the Ball Brothers Foundation awarded on Friday. Funds will purchase a shipping container to house disaster logistics supplies and in-kind donations, to be stored at Delaware County EMS Station 3 and shared across District 6 assets.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve/accept grant funding. Passed Unanimously (00:17:12–00:17:20).
- 00:17:38 **County Building Renovation Request for Proposals (RFP):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner/Staff (00:17:38).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion of the 1969 county building's urgent maintenance needs based on a DLZ analysis estimating a $14 million total cost for full repairs. County Council reduced a $4 million priority-one request down to $750,000 for the 2027 budget. The board discussed issuing an RFP/RFQ for

external building envelope repairs (stopping water intrusion, fixing air gaps around exterior doors) utilizing a 60-day response window.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to issue an RFP with a 60-day submission window. Passed Unanimously (00:19:56–00:20:18).
- 00:20:38 **Purdue Extension 2027 Contractual Services Agreement:**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Becky Marvel, Purdue Extension, alongside new office manager Rachel Vic (00:20:38).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the 2027 contractual agreement. Purdue shifted to a regional population-based service model, increasing fees from roughly $100,000 to $200,434 (a 45% year-over-year increase). Office staff are now Purdue employees rather than county employees, with Rachel Vic's salary/benefits accounting for $55,434 of the total. County Council previously approved funding for this increase during budget hearings.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve the agreement. Passed Unanimously (00:23:07–00:23:18).
- 00:23:37 **Countywide Opioid Settlement Spending Plan:**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Legal (00:23:37).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the finalized countywide opioid settlement spending plan following circulation and minor changes. Letters were sent to towns regarding the consolidation of restricted opioid funds. Daleville and Yorktown placed it on town agendas; Daleville requested funds support *Brianna's Hope*, while Albany representatives requested funds go to *Isaiah's House*.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve the Delaware Countywide Opioid Settlement Spending Plan. Passed Unanimously (00:25:24–00:25:35).
- 00:25:47 **Bridge 118 Repair Quotes (700 South over Bell Creek):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dean Thomas, County Engineer (00:25:47).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Two quotes were received to repair deteriorated piers and eroded abutments on the 70-year-old bridge: (1) Hoosier Pride ($140,750 total) and (2) My Construction LLC ($117,000 total including base peer repair and abutment work). The engineer recommended My Construction LLC. Funding will come from the cumulative bridge fund.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to accept the recommendation of My Construction LLC. Passed Unanimously (00:27:37–00:27:48).
- 00:28:18 **Oakville Tornado Siren Agreements:**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Cory Kirk, Emergency Management (00:28:18).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Approval sought for three agreements related to installing a tornado siren at 601 Gibbons Street (Oakville Park property, grant-funded via an AEP grant): (1) permission to install on park property, (2) homeowner agreement to trim tree limbs for power lines, and (3) Anderson's Grain Terminal agreement to cover monthly electric costs. Kirk also announced a operational policy change:

suspending weekly Friday siren tests when temperatures drop to 36°F or below to prevent ice-build-up motor and fuse damage.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve all three agreements. Passed Unanimously (00:29:45–00:29:56).
- 00:29:45 **Muncie Area Career Center (MACC) EMS Affiliation Agreement:**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley, EMS Network (00:29:23).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Seeking approval for a formal affiliation agreement with MACC to facilitate student ride-alongs, liability mitigation, and hands-on clinical education. Legal reviewed and incorporated HIPAA and indemnification language.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve the request. Passed Unanimously (00:33:00–00:33:08).
- 00:33:30 **Health Plan Document Amendment (Imagine 360):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lee Royal, Human Resources (00:33:33).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to amend the health plan document with Imagine 360 to formally cover telehealth/virtual visits as a major medical expense (tidying up prior operational discussions).
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve. Passed Unanimously (00:33:59–00:34:07).
- 00:34:10 **Ordinance No. 2026-27 (First Reading): Traffic Ordinance Amendment (All-Way Stop at 700 East & 400 South):**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dean Thomas, County Engineer (00:34:29).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed establishing a four-way stop at 700 East and 400 South due to restricted sightlines for east-west traffic coming over a hill. Commissioners requested flashing/spinner attachments on the stop signs and heavy advance warning signage/debrushing.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to introduce the ordinance (with flashers/spinners). Passed Unanimously (00:36:33–00:37:04). *Note: A statutory public hearing will be held at the next commissioners' meeting prior to final adoption.*
- 00:37:41 **Ordinance No. 2026-25 (Second Reading): Junk Vehicles:**
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve. (Roll call initiated 00:37:49).
- 00:38:09 **Ordinance No. 2026-26 (Second Reading): Travel Policy:**
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Board members noted the policy document spans 16 pages and expressed uncertainty regarding specific requested amendments.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to table the ordinance. Passed Unanimously (00:38:32–00:38:42).
- 00:38:49 **Resolution No. 2026-14: Transfer of Properties to Muncie Land Bank:**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Nate Howard (Muncie Land Bank) (00:40:56).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration of a condensed list of 21 unproblematic tax-sale properties to be transferred to the Muncie Land Bank under IC 36-1-11-5.6.

Nate Howard explained the land bank's role as an off-ramp for distressed, abandoned properties to return them to productive use or transfer them to adjacent homeowners.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve the resolution. Passed Unanimously (00:44:31–00:44:38).
- 00:46:26 **Ratification of Boiler RFP Language:**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Staff (00:46:26).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Formal ratification of previously discussed boiler RFP language already posted to the county website.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to ratify. Passed Unanimously (00:46:48–00:46:54).

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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: The public comment period focused heavily on concerns regarding potential hyperscale data centers, utility costs, environmental impacts, and requests for local zoning moratoria.

- 00:12:34 **Sheila Piaza:** Expressed strong objections to potential data center developments near Memorial Drive/AMA, citing lack of moratoriums, noise pollution, water table/White River proximity concerns, and perceived rushing of the process.
- 00:15:14 **Martha Richards:** Spoke as caretaker of Mt. Tabor Cemetery, voicing grave concerns about potential disruptions to historic graves, tombstones, and local farmland from data center developments and heavy utility infrastructure.
- 00:18:51 **Rick Yenser:** Noted historical context of presidential visits to Muncie, discussed past and current industrial/energy projects, and commented on shifting local political and economic landscapes.
- 01:31:31 **Yolanda Jeffers:** Stated that residents feel ignored, gaslit, and unrepresented regarding the data center issue, demanding greater transparency and respectful dialogue from elected officials.
- 01:33:13 **Cheryl Swingley:** Addressed utility affordability, explaining how expedited generation resource plans (EGRPs) and grid modernization costs passed on by investor-owned utilities (AEP/I&M) raise consumer bills. Requested a moratorium on hyperscale data centers.
- 01:36:36 **Misty Moles:** Shared personal opposition to data centers near her property on Jackson Street, highlighting potential impacts on health, well-being, homeowner insurance cancellations, well water, and local ecosystems.
- 01:40:55 **Philip Kalpert:** Spoke as a Maple Manor resident and AMA member, stating that general AMA members were kept in the dark by executive leadership regarding data center talks, and asked the board to institute a 1-year moratorium.

- 01:45:03 **Valerie Tony:** Voiced concerns regarding sound/light pollution, water resource strain, and lack of transparency surrounding industrial data centers, noting that over 500 citizen signatures had been gathered.
- 01:48:24 **Sam Harris:** Discussed the massive scale of AI data center "brains" (comparing them spatially to hundreds of football fields), energy grid demands, and software reliability/security concerns.
- 02:16:16 **Linda Hansen:** Speaking for the League of Women Voters, highlighted Indiana's utility affordability crisis, high energy burdens on low-income households, and utility disconnect rates, urging a 6-to-12-month data center moratorium.
- 01:59:32 **C. Anne Rolig:** Expressed appreciation for active community members and challenged commissioners to be proactive, transparent, and fully informed regarding AMA and data center discussions.

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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
  - **Human Resources (Lee Royal):** Open enrollment runs November 10–20 with call-center and self-service options; Marathon Health clinic now offers e-visits; 457(b) voluntary retirement education ongoing; successful participation at the East Indiana Works career fair (00:49:49–00:51:37).
  - **Treasurer (Brad Hulk):** Provided October 14 tax sale results (out of 1,217 certified properties totaling $5.4M due, 573 paid prior to sale totaling $1.35M; 487 offered, 183 sold raising $3.77M with $3.22M surplus; 303 unsold properties remaining for future sales or deed sales) (00:51:44–00:54:18).
  - **Highway Department (Tommy / Dean):** Provided updates on ditch line structures on 700 East, Summer Hill work near Albany, FEMA reimbursement projects on Northwood Drive, and stormwater updates for Ken Drive (01:01:36–01:03:08).
  - **Emergency Management / Tower Fund:** Discussion regarding utilizing remaining EMS billing/retirement funds ($525,000) for 911 tower restoration at Samson following flood damage, pending a formal tower restoration fund ordinance (01:06:57–01:09:05).
- **Claims & Financial Approvals:**
  - Payment of Claims: $1,368,657.14 (01:09:48–01:10:11).
  - ARP Claims: $2,987.82 (01:11:29–01:11:46).
  - Payroll (November 4, 2026): $1,088,871.22 (01:11:46–01:12:01).
- **Adjournment:** The board voted to recess for 10 minutes prior to transitioning into the Stormwater Board meeting (01:12:13–02:09:12).

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